hotel staff did the same, warning guests to lock their doors, switch off the lights and not to flush the toilet or make any other sounds. One guest recounted receiving received three calls, which he did not answer, and subsequently discovered two came from terrorists checking to see if the room was occupied.[33]

The Trident-Oberoi Hotel also has two wings. Immediately after entering the Trident wing, Abdul Rehman Chhota [a.k.a. Saakib] from Multan Road and Fahadullah from Kasoor Road began firing indiscriminately before detonating an IED in the hotel's tea lounge.[34] The two gunmen killed or wounded a number of people in the hotel's Tiffin restaurant, before rounding up hostages and heading to the Oberoi wing of the hotel. Among their hostages were two Muslims, a husband and wife from Turkey. Obeying instructions not to kill Muslims at the hotels, the gunmen spared the Turks telling them 'No kill. You brothers.' A Lashkar handler later instructed the fidayeen to kill their remaining hostages, all of whom were women.[35] One of the attackers at the Trident-Oberoi also phoned the news media and, claiming there were seven terrorists in the building, demanded that India release all the imprisoned mujahideen in return for the hostages.[36] This contributed to confusion among the authorities about the number of terrorists they faced and the nature of the operation; i.e. whether it was a hostage situation or a mass casualty attack. Seventeen hours elapsed before Indian forces retook control of the hotel and killed the two terrorists who, by then, had murdered thirty-five people.[37] Fahadullah took refuge in a bathroom after his partner was killed. It took several phone calls from a Lashkar handler before he was ready to emerge for a final showdown. During those conversations, recorded by Indian intelligence, Fahadullah was told he mustn't allow himself to be arrested. 'For your mission to end successfully,' his handler sternly reminded him, 'you must be killed.'[38]

The Chabad House is as obscure as the Taj Mahal and Trident-Oberoi hotels are famous. Formerly known as Nariman House, it was purchased in 2006 by the Chabad Liberation Movement of Hasidic Jews and subsequently renamed. A rabbi lived there along with his family and the building generally accommodated Jewish tourists, especially Americans and Israelis, visiting India. One of Lashkar's handlers in Pakistan told the attackers that because this was a Jewish target, every person killed there